

Standard / Generation	Year Ratified	Frequency Band	PHY Standard	Max Data Rate	Modulation Techniques
802.11 Prime	1997	2.4 GHz ISM	DSSS, FHSS, IR	2 Mbps	Barker Code
802.11b	1999	2.4 GHz ISM	HR-DSSS	11 Mbps	CCK
802.11a	1999	5 GHz U-NII	OFDM	54 Mbps	BPSK, QPSK, 16-QAM, 64-QAM
802.11g	2003	2.4 GHz ISM	ERP (ERP-OFDM & ERP-DSSS)	54 Mbps	OFDM (Up to 64-QAM), CCK
802.11n (Wi-Fi 4)	2009	2.4 GHz & 5 GHz	HT (MIMO + OFDM)	600 Mbps	Up to 64-QAM
802.11ac (Wi-Fi 5)	2013	5 GHz (below 6 GHz)	VHT (MU-MIMO)	6933.3 Mbps	256-QAM
802.11ad (WiGig)	2012	60 GHz	DMG	7 Gbps	SQPSK, QPSK, 16-QAM, 64-QAM
802.11af	2014	TV White Space (54–790 MHz)	TVHT (OFDM based)	568 Mbps	Up to 256-QAM
802.11ah (HaLow)	2016	Sub-1 GHz	Wi-Fi HaLow	~347 Mbps	BPSK, QPSK, up to 256-QAM
802.11ax (Wi-Fi 6/6E)	2021	2.4 GHz, 5 GHz, 6 GHz	HE (OFDMA)	9.6 Gbps	Up to 1024-QAM
802.11be (Wi-Fi 7)	2024	2.4 GHz, 5 GHz, 6 GHz	EHT	46 Gbps	Up to 4096-QAM
802.11bn (Wi-Fi 8)	Draft (Est. 2028)	2.4 GHz, 5 GHz, 6 GHz	UHR (Ultra High Reliability)	46 Gbps	Up to 4096-QAM